

7.5–12 mm
3/16–1/2 in

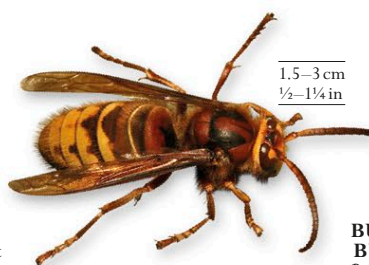


TIPHID WASP
Methocha articulata
F: Tiphidae

The wingless females of this European species live in sandy areas, where they are a parasite on the larvae of tiger beetles inside their burrows.

HORNET
Vespa crabro
F: Vespidae

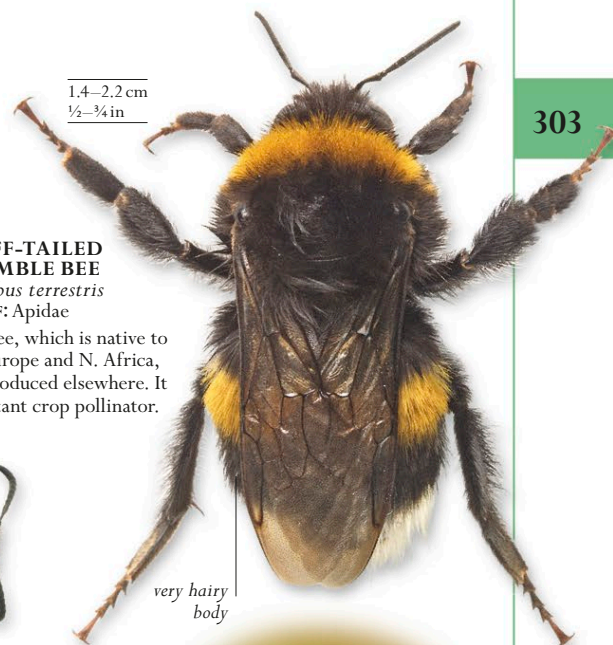
This large social wasp lives in Europe and Asia and has been introduced elsewhere. It favours woodland, where it makes its nest in hollow trees.



1.5–3 cm
1/2–1 1/4 in

BUFF-TAILED BUMBLE BEE
Bombus terrestris
F: Apidae

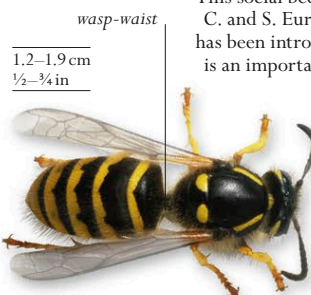
This social bee, which is native to C. and S. Europe and N. Africa, has been introduced elsewhere. It is an important crop pollinator.



very hairy body

COMMON WASP
Vespula vulgaris
F: Vespidae

Native to the northern hemisphere, this wasp feeds its young on insects and makes a paper nest from chewed wood fibres.



1.2–1.9 cm
1/2–3/4 in

wasp-waist

TAWNY MINING BEE
Andrena fulva
F: Andrenidae

Found in C. Europe, this early spring bee makes a nest underground in grassy areas, raising a little mound of soil at the entrance.



1.2–1.6 cm
1/2 in

HONEY BEE
Apis mellifera
F: Apidae

The western honey bee, an important crop pollinator, is now found worldwide. In the wild it nests in hollow trees, but is widely kept in domestic hives.



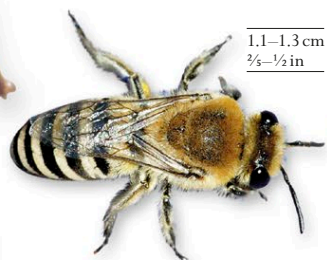
1.2–1.4 cm
1/2 in



ORCHID BEE
Euglossa asarophora
F: Apidae

Like all orchid bees, this species lives in colonies in the rainforests of S. America. Males collect oils and resins from orchids to attract a mate.

1.1–1.3 cm
2/5–1/2 in



PLASTERER BEE
Colletes sp.
F: Colletidae

These solitary, ground-nesting bees are common across the northern hemisphere. They line their nests with a waterproof abdominal secretion.



3.3–3.6 cm
1 1/4–1 1/2 in

GREAT CARPENTER BEE
Xylocopa latipes
F: Anthophoridae

Found all over S.E. Asia, this large bee excavates nest cavities in tree branches or wooden timbers and posts.

5–9 mm
3/16–1 1/32 in



WOOD ANT
Formica rufa
F: Formicidae

Common throughout Europe, this ant is an important predator of insects in forests. It squirts formic acid from the rear of its abdomen as a defence.



1.6 cm
5/8 in

LEAF-CUTTER ANT
Atta sp.
F: Formicidae

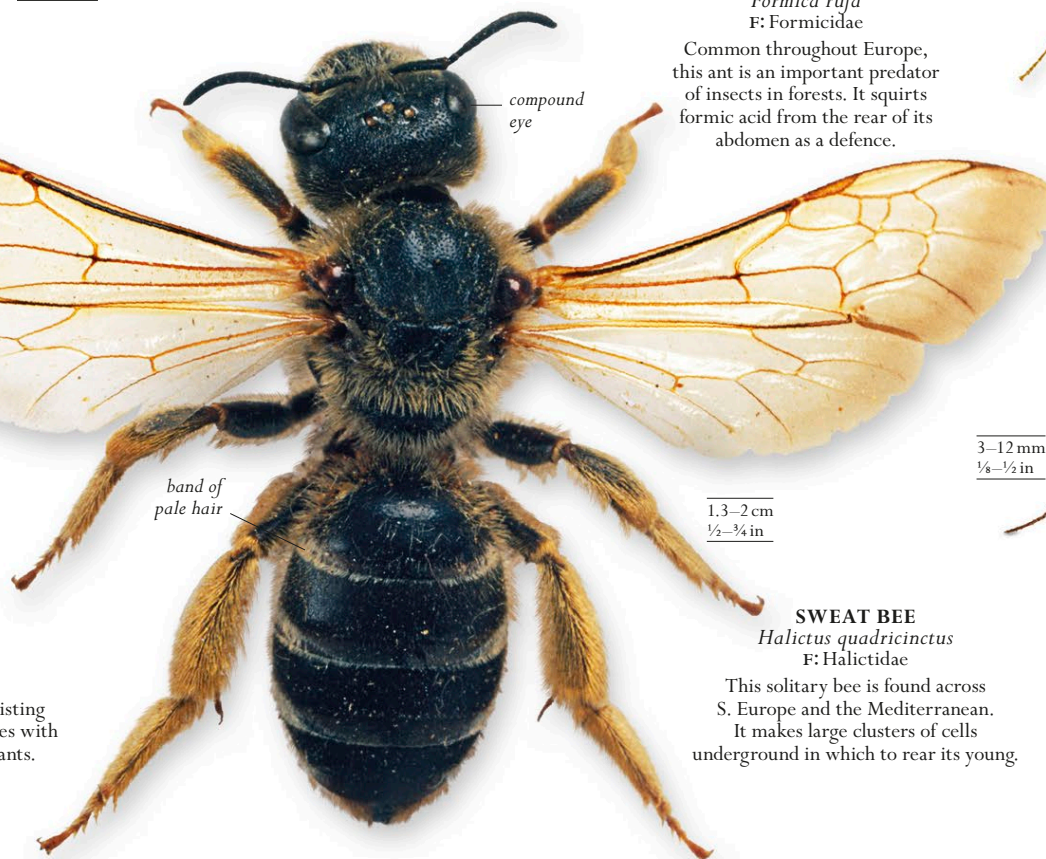
Leaf-cutter ants live in C. and S. America. They can make vast underground nests, where they cultivate a special fungus on chewed leaf fragments as food.



1.1–1.7 cm
3/8–1/2 in

WOOL CARDER BEE
Anthidium manicatum
F: Megachilidae

This European bee makes nests in existing holes in wood or masonry, which it lines with hairs that it collects from certain plants.



compound eye

band of pale hair

1.3–2 cm
1/2–3/4 in

SWEAT BEE
Halictus quadricinctus
F: Halictidae

This solitary bee is found across S. Europe and the Mediterranean. It makes large clusters of cells underground in which to rear its young.



3–12 mm
1/8–1/2 in

ARMY ANT
Eciton burchellii
F: Formicidae

This S. American ant forms large colonies of up to 2 million individuals and attacks large prey.